

A “race to weaken hunting laws”?

BirdLife Malta's claim about Labour and the PN, tested

THE CLAIM

“...dangerous political race to weaken environmental enforcement”

BirdLife Malta, press release headline, 27 May 2026

Issued three days before the 2026 general election.

Fines for shooting protected birds have not been cut: they are only proposed.

VERDICT

NOT SUBSTANTIATED

*Shown for Labour;
not shown for the PN.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

Items 63–64

Labour manifesto

Safeguards hunting within EU-permitted derogations; nothing on fines.

-40%

Reported ORNIS proposal

Fines for shooting protected birds: EUR 5,000 to 3,000 and 10,000 to 6,000.

“Safeguarded”

Alex Borg, PN, 26 May

No mention of the Birds Directive, fines or licences.

0 of 16

PN programme chapters

None has a hunting or trapping item.

EUR 5,000

Fine in force today

First conviction; EUR 10,000 for a repeat. No 2026 amendment found.

FAIR TO SAY

The Labour side is documented. The PN side rests on one pledge and a reading of EU law.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ BirdLife Malta: sources for the candidate claims.

☐ Government: the ORNIS presentation and minutes.

☐ PN: does 'safeguarded' include penalties?

☐ PN: any hunting item beyond the programme?